

General Knowledge

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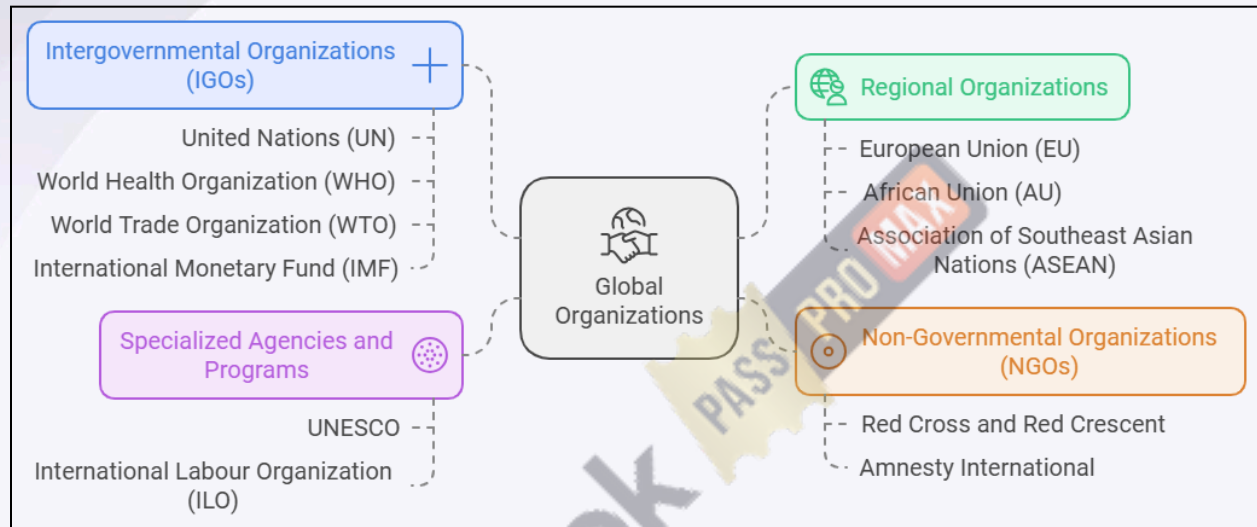
STUDY NOTES

World Organisations



World Organisations

World organizations are entities that aim to promote cooperation, address global challenges, and work towards peace, stability, and development. These organizations can be intergovernmental, non-governmental, or multilateral, and they play a significant role in shaping international policy and actions.



Roles and Functions

- **Peace and Security**
 - Organizations like the UN, NATO, and ICC work to resolve conflicts and ensure global security.
- **Economic Development**
 - Institutions such as the IMF, World Bank, and WTO aim to stabilize economies, reduce poverty, and promote trade.
- **Public Health**
 - WHO leads international efforts in managing pandemics, healthcare systems, and disease prevention.
- **Human Rights and Justice**
 - Bodies like the ICC and the UN Human Rights Council protect fundamental rights and prosecute crimes against humanity.
- **Cultural and Scientific Cooperation**

- UNESCO focuses on education, cultural heritage, and fostering global scientific collaboration.

List of Regional Organizations

Organization	Headquarters	Date of Establishment	Description
European Union (EU)	Brussels, Belgium	1993 (Maastricht Treaty)	A political and economic union of 27 European countries aimed at fostering economic cooperation, free trade, and political stability.
Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN)	Jakarta, Indonesia	8 August 1967	A regional organization of 10 Southeast Asian countries promoting economic, political, and security cooperation.
African Union (AU)	Addis Ababa, Ethiopia	26 May 2001 (OAU in 1963)	An organization of African nations promoting unity, economic integration, and conflict resolution on the continent.
South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC)	Kathmandu, Nepal	8 December 1985	An association of 8 South Asian nations aimed at promoting regional cooperation in economic, cultural, and social development.
Arab League	Cairo, Egypt	22 March 1945	A regional organization of Arab countries in the Middle East and North Africa focusing on economic, cultural, and political cooperation.
Organization of American States (OAS)	Washington, D.C., USA	30 April 1948	An organization of 35 countries in the Americas promoting democracy, human rights, security, and economic

			development.
Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC)	Riyadh, Saudi Arabia	25 May 1981	A regional intergovernmental organization comprising six Gulf countries, focusing on economic, security, and political cooperation.
Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS)	Minsk, Belarus	8 December 1991	A regional organization of former Soviet Republics aiming to foster cooperation in economic and political fields.
Caribbean Community (CARICOM)	Georgetown, Guyana	4 July 1973	A regional organization of Caribbean nations promoting economic integration, cooperation in trade, and coordinated foreign policies.
Pacific Islands Forum (PIF)	Suva, Fiji	5 August 1971	A political and economic policy organization of Pacific Island countries aiming at regional cooperation and sustainable development.
Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO)	Beijing, China	15 June 2001	A Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance focusing on cooperation against terrorism, economic development, and cultural exchange.
Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)	Abuja, Nigeria	28 May 1975	A regional group of West African countries promoting economic integration, security, and good governance.
Southern African Development	Gaborone, Botswana	17 August 1992	A regional body of Southern African countries working towards socio-economic development and

Community (SADC)			regional integration.
Central American Integration System (SICA)	San Salvador, El Salvador	13 December 1991	An organization of Central American countries focusing on regional integration and sustainable development.
North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA) (replaced by USMCA)	Mexico City, Ottawa, Washington, D.C.	1 January 1994 (replaced 2020)	A trade agreement between the USA, Canada, and Mexico for free trade, now replaced by the United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA).
Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC)	Dhaka, Bangladesh	6 June 1997	A regional organization of countries around the Bay of Bengal promoting technical and economic cooperation.
Andean Community (CAN)	Lima, Peru	26 May 1969	A South American organization focused on economic and social integration among its member states.

Intergovernmental Organizations (IGOs)

Organization	Headquarters	Date of Establishment	Description
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United Nations (UN)	New York, USA	24 October 1945	A global organization aimed at maintaining international peace and security, fostering cooperation, and promoting human rights.
World Bank Group (WBG)	Washington, D.C., USA	1944 (Bretton Woods Conf.)	Provides financial and technical assistance to developing countries for development programs.
International Monetary Fund (IMF)	Washington, D.C., USA	27 December 1945	Promotes global monetary cooperation, financial stability, and economic growth among member nations.
World Trade Organization (WTO)	Geneva, Switzerland	1 January 1995	Deals with the global rules of trade between nations to ensure smooth, predictable, and free trade.
North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)	Brussels, Belgium	4 April 1949	A military alliance aimed at ensuring the collective defense of its member nations.
European Union (EU)	Brussels, Belgium	1 November 1993	A political and economic union of 27 European countries fostering cooperation and integration.
Commonwealth of Nations	London, UK	1931 (Statute of Westminster)	A voluntary association of 56 independent and equal sovereign states, most of them former territories of the British Empire.
Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC)	Vienna, Austria	14 September 1960	Coordinates and unifies petroleum policies among member countries to stabilize oil markets.
International Criminal Court (ICC)	The Hague, Netherlands	1 July 2002	Prosecutes individuals for war crimes, genocide, crimes against humanity, and aggression.

World Health Organization (WHO)	Geneva, Switzerland	7 April 1948	Directs and coordinates international health within the UN system.
United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)	Paris, France	16 November 1945	Promotes international collaboration in education, science, and culture.
International Labour Organization (ILO)	Geneva, Switzerland	11 April 1919	Focuses on labor issues, including international labor standards, social protection, and working conditions.
Interpol	Lyon, France	7 September 1923	Facilitates international police cooperation to combat transnational crime.
International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA)	Vienna, Austria	29 July 1957	Promotes safe, secure, and peaceful use of nuclear energy.
G7 (Group of Seven)	Rotating locations	1975	An informal group of the world's major advanced economies for addressing global economic and political issues.
African Union (AU)	Addis Ababa, Ethiopia	26 May 2001 (OAU in 1963)	Promotes unity, socio-economic development, and peace among African nations.
Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)	Paris, France	30 September 1961	Promotes policies that improve economic and social well-being worldwide.

G20 (Group of Twenty)	Rotating locations	26 September 1999	An international forum for governments and central bank governors from 19 countries and the EU addressing global financial issues.
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Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)

Organization	Headquarters	Date of Establishment	Description
Amnesty International	London, UK	1961	Focuses on human rights advocacy, campaigning against abuses of human rights globally.
Doctors Without Borders (Médecins Sans Frontières, MSF)	Geneva, Switzerland	22 December 1971	Provides medical aid to people affected by conflict, epidemics, disasters, or exclusion from healthcare.
Greenpeace	Amsterdam, Netherlands	1971	An environmental organization campaigning for issues like climate change, deforestation, and renewable energy.
Oxfam	Nairobi, Kenya	1942	Works to alleviate global poverty through advocacy, development programs, and emergency relief.
Red Cross (International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, IFRC)	Geneva, Switzerland	1919	Provides humanitarian aid during emergencies, promoting health and assisting in disaster relief.
World Wildlife Fund (WWF)	Gland, Switzerland	29 April 1961	Works on conservation of nature, reducing environmental footprint, and

			protecting endangered species.
Save the Children	London, UK	1919	Focuses on improving children's lives through education, healthcare, and emergency aid worldwide.
Transparency International	Berlin, Germany	1993	Combats global corruption and promotes transparency, accountability, and integrity in governance.
Human Rights Watch	New York, USA	1978	Monitors and reports on human rights abuses worldwide, advocating for justice and accountability.
CARE International	Geneva, Switzerland	1945	Provides humanitarian aid and development programs, focusing on eradicating poverty and achieving social justice.
Plan International	Woking, UK	1937	Promotes children's rights and equality for girls in over 70 countries.
The Nature Conservancy	Arlington, USA	1951	Focuses on environmental conservation, particularly land and water preservation.
Rotary International	Evanston, Illinois, USA	1905	A global service organization focusing on humanitarian projects, including health, education, and disaster relief.
ActionAid	Johannesburg, South Africa	1972	Works to fight poverty and injustice in developing countries, focusing on rights-based approaches.
Relief International	Washington, D.C., USA	1990	Provides emergency relief, education, and healthcare in fragile settings and developing nations.
International Rescue Committee (IRC)	New York, USA	1933	Offers emergency assistance and long-term support to refugees and those displaced by conflict and

			disaster.
Habitat for Humanity	Atlanta, USA	1976	Helps build affordable housing for low-income families worldwide.
BRAC (Bangladesh Rural Advancement Committee)	Dhaka, Bangladesh	1972	Focuses on poverty alleviation through programs in education, healthcare, and microfinance.
WaterAid	London, UK	1981	Aims to provide clean water, sanitation, and hygiene to communities in need worldwide.
Global Fund for Women	San Francisco, USA	1987	Supports gender equality and women's rights through grants and advocacy initiatives.

Specialized Agencies

Agency	Headquarters	Date of Establishment	Description
World Health Organization (WHO)	Geneva, Switzerland	7 April 1948	Coordinates international health activities, addresses global health issues, and supports healthcare improvements.
Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)	Rome, Italy	16 October 1945	Focuses on eradicating hunger, improving nutrition, and promoting sustainable agriculture worldwide.
United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural	Paris, France	16 November 1945	Promotes international collaboration in education, science, and culture to foster peace and sustainable development.

Organization (UNESCO)			
International Monetary Fund (IMF)	Washington, D.C., USA	27 December 1945	Promotes international monetary cooperation, financial stability, and economic growth among member countries.
World Bank Group (WBG)	Washington, D.C., USA	1944 (Bretton Woods Conf.)	Provides financial and technical assistance to developing countries for development and poverty reduction.
International Labour Organization (ILO)	Geneva, Switzerland	11 April 1919	Develops international labor standards and promotes decent work and social justice.
World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)	Geneva, Switzerland	14 July 1967	Promotes the protection of intellectual property rights worldwide and fosters innovation and creativity.
International Telecommunica- tion Union (ITU)	Geneva, Switzerland	17 May 1865	Coordinates global use of the radio spectrum, satellite orbits, and telecommunication standards.
United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO)	Vienna, Austria	17 November 1966	Promotes industrial development for poverty reduction, inclusive globalization, and environmental sustainability.
International Civil Aviation Organization	Montreal, Canada	4 April 1947	Sets standards and regulations for aviation safety, security, efficiency, and environmental

(ICAO)			protection.
Universal Postal Union (UPU)	Bern, Switzerland	9 October 1874	Facilitates and coordinates international postal services to ensure efficient and accessible global delivery systems.
World Meteorological Organization (WMO)	Geneva, Switzerland	23 March 1950	Promotes international cooperation in meteorology, climatology, hydrology, and geophysical sciences.
International Maritime Organization (IMO)	London, UK	17 March 1948	Focuses on improving maritime safety, security, and environmental performance of international shipping.
International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)	Rome, Italy	15 December 1977	Provides funding and support to eradicate rural poverty and enhance food security in developing nations.
World Tourism Organization (UNWTO)	Madrid, Spain	2 January 1975	Promotes sustainable and responsible tourism to foster development and cultural understanding.
United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)	New York, USA	22 November 1965	Works to eradicate poverty, reduce inequalities, and build resilience to crises through sustainable development projects.

Environmental Organizations worldwide

Organization Name	Headquarters	Date of Establishment	Description
United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)	Nairobi, Kenya	5 June 1972	Coordinates global environmental activities, promotes sustainable development, and monitors environmental conditions worldwide.
World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF)	Gland, Switzerland	29 April 1961	Focuses on conservation of biodiversity, reducing human environmental impact, and promoting sustainable use of resources.
Greenpeace International	Amsterdam, Netherlands	1971	Advocates for environmental protection through direct action, lobbying, and public awareness campaigns.
International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)	Gland, Switzerland	5 October 1948	Works to conserve nature and ensure sustainable use of natural resources through global cooperation.
The Nature Conservancy (TNC)	Arlington, Virginia, USA	1951	Focuses on global conservation efforts to protect ecologically important lands, waters, and biodiversity.
World Resources Institute (WRI)	Washington, D.C., USA	1982	Provides data and policy recommendations on issues such as climate change, energy, and sustainable development.
Friends of the Earth International	Amsterdam, Netherlands	1971	Advocates for environmental justice and sustainability while opposing activities harmful to ecosystems and communities.

Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)	Geneva, Switzerland	1988	Provides scientific assessments on climate change, its impacts, and strategies for adaptation and mitigation.
Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)	Montreal, Canada	1992	Promotes global cooperation to conserve biodiversity, ensure sustainable use, and share benefits arising from genetic resources.
Global Environment Facility (GEF)	Washington, D.C., USA	1991	Provides financial support for projects addressing global environmental challenges, including biodiversity and climate change.
Rainforest Alliance	New York City, USA	1987	Promotes sustainable farming, forestry, and tourism to conserve biodiversity and improve livelihoods.
International Institute for Environment and Development (IIED)	London, UK	1971	Focuses on sustainable development, climate resilience, and equity in environmental governance.
World Meteorological Organization (WMO)	Geneva, Switzerland	23 March 1950	Provides leadership in monitoring weather, climate, and hydrological data for sustainable development.
International Whaling Commission (IWC)	Cambridge, UK	1946	Manages whale conservation and sustainable whaling practices globally.

Forest Stewardship Council (FSC)	Bonn, Germany	1993	Promotes responsible management of the world's forests through certification and advocacy.
United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC)	Bonn, Germany	21 March 1994	Leads international efforts to combat climate change and reduce greenhouse gas emissions.
Earthwatch Institute	Boston, Massachusetts, USA	1971	Engages individuals and organizations in scientific field research and education to promote environmental sustainability.
Climate Action Network (CAN)	Bonn, Germany	1989	A global network of NGOs focused on climate change advocacy, policy development, and awareness campaigns.
International Solar Alliance (ISA)	Gurugram, India	30 November 2015	Promotes solar energy deployment in tropical countries to combat climate change and reduce reliance on fossil fuels.

Defence Organizations worldwide

Organization Name	Headquarters	Date of Establishment	Description
North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)	Brussels, Belgium	4 April 1949	A military alliance of 31 member countries committed to collective defense and crisis management.

United Nations Department of Peace Operations (UN DPO)	New York City, USA	1948	Oversees UN peacekeeping operations to maintain international peace and security.
Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE)	Vienna, Austria	1 January 1975	Focuses on arms control, border management, and conflict prevention in Europe, North America, and Asia.
European Defence Agency (EDA)	Brussels, Belgium	12 July 2004	Coordinates defence capabilities and technological cooperation among EU member states.
Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)	Beijing, China	15 June 2001	Focuses on regional security, counterterrorism, and economic cooperation among its Eurasian members.
Common Security and Defence Policy (CSDP)	Brussels, Belgium	1999	Part of the EU's framework for defense and crisis management, promoting peace and security globally.
African Union Peace and Security Council (AU PSC)	Addis Ababa, Ethiopia	26 May 2004	Addresses conflict prevention, peacekeeping, and defense in African Union member states.
Collective Security Treaty Organization (CSTO)	Moscow, Russia	15 May 1992	A military alliance of former Soviet states focusing on collective defense and regional stability.
International Institute for Strategic Studies (IISS)	London, UK	1958	A global think tank providing analysis on international security and defense issues.

Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation Security Framework (APEC Security)	Singapore	1989	Addresses regional security and defense collaboration among Asia-Pacific nations.
Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA)	Arlington, Virginia, USA	7 February 1958	Develops advanced technologies for national security and defense in the United States.
Interpol (International Criminal Police Organization)	Lyon, France	7 September 1923	Facilitates international police cooperation to combat transnational crime and terrorism.
International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA)	Vienna, Austria	29 July 1957	Promotes the peaceful use of nuclear energy and safeguards to prevent nuclear weapons proliferation.
Nuclear Threat Initiative (NTI)	Washington, D.C., USA	2001	Works to prevent the spread of nuclear, biological, and chemical weapons globally.
Regional Cooperation Agreement on Combating Piracy and Armed Robbery (ReCAAP)	Singapore	2006	Aims to enhance regional cooperation to combat piracy and armed robbery against ships in Asia.
International Maritime Organization	London, UK	17 March 1948	Focuses on maritime safety, security, and environmental protection, including combating

(IMO)			piracy.
Global Counterterrorism Forum (GCTF)	The Hague, Netherlands	22 September 2011	A multilateral platform for counterterrorism capacity-building and cooperation.
United States Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM)	Honolulu, Hawaii, USA	1 January 1947	Oversees military operations in the Indo-Pacific region to maintain regional security.
Five Eyes Alliance	No fixed headquarters	1941	An intelligence-sharing alliance among the US, UK, Canada, Australia, and New Zealand.

Trade Blocs worldwide

Trade Bloc Name	Headquarters	Date of Establishment	Description
North American Free Trade Agreement (NAFTA)	Washington, D.C., USA	1 January 1994	A trilateral agreement between the USA, Canada, and Mexico to eliminate trade barriers and enhance economic cooperation (replaced by USMCA in 2020).
Mercosur (Southern Common Market)	Montevideo, Uruguay	26 March 1991	A South American trade bloc including Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay, and Uruguay, aimed at promoting economic integration.
ASEAN Free Trade Area (AFTA)	Jakarta, Indonesia	28 January 1992	A trade bloc among 10 Southeast Asian countries aimed at reducing tariffs and increasing economic

			cooperation.
Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP)	Ottawa, Canada	30 December 2018	A trade agreement among 11 countries across the Pacific Rim aimed at enhancing trade and economic integration.
African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA)	Addis Ababa, Ethiopia	30 May 2019	A continent-wide trade agreement among African Union member states to create a single market for goods and services.
Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)	Abuja, Nigeria	28 May 1975	A group of 15 West African countries promoting economic integration and cooperation in trade, security, and political matters.
Pacific Alliance	Santiago, Chile	6 April 2011	A trade bloc consisting of Chile, Colombia, Mexico, and Peru, aimed at fostering economic integration and cooperation in Latin America.
Arab Maghreb Union (UMA)	Algiers, Algeria	17 February 1989	A regional trade bloc of North African countries, aimed at promoting economic and political cooperation, though currently inactive.
Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU)	Moscow, Russia	1 January 2015	An economic union among Russia, Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, and Kyrgyzstan, aimed at improving trade and economic integration in Eurasia.

Union of South American Nations (UNASUR)	Quito, Ecuador	23 May 2008	A trade and political union in South America aimed at regional integration and development (currently inactive).
South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA)	Dhaka, Bangladesh	6 January 2006	A trade agreement among SAARC (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation) members to reduce tariffs and promote trade in South Asia.
Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS)	Minsk, Belarus	8 December 1991	A regional organization of former Soviet republics aimed at promoting economic cooperation and integration among its members.
Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC)	Riyadh, Saudi Arabia	25 May 1981	A political and economic union of six Gulf Arab countries to enhance economic cooperation and security.
Central European Free Trade Agreement (CEFTA)	Bratislava, Slovakia	21 December 1992	A trade agreement among non-EU countries in Central and Eastern Europe, aimed at reducing trade barriers and promoting integration.
Caribbean Community (CARICOM)	Georgetown, Guyana	4 July 1973	An organization of 15 Caribbean nations promoting regional integration and cooperation in trade and economics.
Andean Community (CAN)	Lima, Peru	26 May 1969	A trade bloc consisting of Bolivia, Colombia, Ecuador, and Peru, focused on regional integration and economic development.

Southern African Development Community (SADC)	Gaborone, Botswana	17 August 1992	A regional organization of Southern African countries aimed at promoting regional trade, development, and security.
BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation)	Dhaka, Bangladesh	6 June 1997	A regional organization of countries in South Asia and Southeast Asia focused on trade, connectivity, and economic cooperation.